

Name: _____ Date: _____ Score: _____ / 30

Reading Comprehension Test

Nehemiah and Esther - Bible
by Old Testament

Directions: Circle the letter of the best answer for each question.

Section 1: Easy

1. [Nehemiah] Which Persian king gave Nehemiah permission to go to Jerusalem?

- A. Cyrus
- B. Artaxerxes
- C. Nebuchadnezzar
- D. Darius

2. [Esther] Which young Jewish woman became queen of Persia?

- A. Ruth
- B. Vashti
- C. Esther
- D. Deborah

3. [Nehemiah] What city was Nehemiah especially burdened to help rebuild?

- A. Jerusalem
- B. The northern capital city of Samaria
- C. Bethlehem
- D. Susa

4. [Esther] Who was Esther's older cousin and guardian?

- A. One of Haman's royal servants
- B. Ezra
- C. Daniel
- D. Mordecai

5. [Nehemiah] Which two opponents mocked and resisted the wall rebuilding?

- A. Haman and Harbona
- B. Saul and Jonathan
- C. Sanballat and Tobiah
- D. Ahasuerus and Memucan

6. [Esther] Who plotted to destroy the Jews throughout the Persian Empire?

- A. Haman
- B. Mordecai
- C. Bigthan
- D. Nehemiah

7. [Nehemiah] What did Ezra read aloud to the gathered people?

- A. The king's tax records
- B. The Law of Moses
- C. The letters from Haman
- D. The names of Persian soldiers

8. [Esther] What was the name of the Persian king in Esther?

- A. Solomon
- B. Hezekiah
- C. Artaxerxes
- D. Ahasuerus

9. [Nehemiah] What job did Nehemiah have before going to Jerusalem?

- A. One of the temple musicians in Jerusalem
- B. Army commander
- C. Cupbearer to the king
- D. Goldsmith

10. [Esther] What feast celebrates the Jews' deliverance in Esther?

- A. Purim
- B. Passover
- C. Pentecost
- D. Booths

Section 2: Medium

11. [Nehemiah] Why was Nehemiah sad when he came before King Artaxerxes?

- A. He had been ordered to abandon every Jewish family still living in Persia
- B. He wanted to become king of Persia
- C. He had been accused by Esther
- D. He had heard that Jerusalem's wall was broken and its gates were burned

12. [Esther] Why did Esther not reveal her Jewish identity at first?

- A. She had forgotten her family background
- B. Mordecai had instructed her to keep it hidden
- C. The king already knew and asked her to stay silent
- D. Haman promised to protect her secret

13. [Nehemiah] What does Nehemiah's quick prayer before answering the king show?

- A. He depended on God even while making a wise request
- B. He did not know anything about Jerusalem's condition
- C. He wanted the king to forget the conversation
- D. He believed planning was unnecessary

14. [Esther] Why was it dangerous for Esther to approach the king without being called?

- A. Only Haman was allowed to speak in the palace
- B. The law required queens to live outside the city
- C. She could be put to death unless the king extended his scepter
- D. Mordecai had ordered every Jew in Susa to avoid the palace forever

15. [Nehemiah] Why did the builders work with weapons nearby?

- A. They were planning to attack Persia first
- B. They were training to become a new royal guard for Artaxerxes and leave Jerusalem unfinished
- C. They wanted to frighten Ezra away from Jerusalem
- D. Their enemies threatened them, so they guarded the work while continuing it

16. [Esther] Why did Mordecai refuse to bow to Haman?

- A. He would not give Haman the honor Haman demanded

- B. He did not understand the king's language
- C. He was trying to become prime minister himself without Esther's knowledge
- D. He had already been sentenced to death

17. [Nehemiah] How did Nehemiah respond when wealthy Jews were taking advantage of poorer Jews?

- A. He ignored the complaint until the wall was finished and the poor families left Jerusalem
- B. He confronted the nobles and called them to return what they had taken
- C. He asked Sanballat to judge the case
- D. He sold the poor families to raise money for the wall

18. [Esther] Why was Esther's banquet strategy wise?

- A. It gave Haman time to repent publicly before anyone accused him
- B. It allowed Mordecai to become king before the second banquet
- C. It created the right moment to expose Haman's plot before the king
- D. It convinced the Jews to leave Persia before danger came without telling the king

19. [Nehemiah] After the people wept while hearing the Law, what did Nehemiah and the leaders tell them to do?

- A. Rejoice, share food, and remember that the joy of the Lord was their strength
- B. Stop reading the Law because it made people too emotional to obey anything
- C. Leave Jerusalem until the walls were stronger
- D. Choose a new Persian governor immediately

20. [Esther] What happened after the king could not sleep and heard the royal records read?

- A. Esther was removed as queen that night for delaying her request
- B. Haman was promoted without delay
- C. The Jews were ordered to leave Susa
- D. Mordecai's earlier loyalty was remembered and honored

Section 3: Hard

21. [Nehemiah] What kind of leadership does Nehemiah model throughout the book?

- A. A leader who avoids conflict by letting injustice continue
- B. A leader who trusts walls more than God
- C. A leader who combines prayer, planning, courage, and reform
- D. A leader who succeeds by flattering every enemy

22. [Esther] What major theme is shown even though God's name is not directly mentioned in Esther?

- A. God only works when people see miracles immediately and publicly
- B. God can preserve His people through timing, courage, and ordinary events
- C. Human courage matters only when rulers are kind
- D. Exile means God's covenant promises have ended

23. [Nehemiah] Why is rebuilding Jerusalem's wall about more than construction?

- A. It helps restore the community's worship, identity, protection, and covenant faithfulness
- B. It proves Jerusalem no longer needs the Law of Moses
- C. It replaces the temple as the only place God can be worshiped
- D. It lets Nehemiah become king over all Persia

24. [Esther] What does Mordecai's challenge about Esther coming to the kingdom for such a time suggest?

- A. Esther can save the Jews without risking anything

- B. Mordecai believes Haman has already changed his mind
- C. The king's law is more powerful than God's purposes in every situation
- D. Esther has a responsibility to use her position courageously

25. [Nehemiah] How do prayer and practical action work together in Nehemiah?

- A. Prayer replaces the need for inspection, organization, and hard work
- B. Nehemiah prays seriously and then acts with careful planning and perseverance
- C. Nehemiah acts first and only prays after every plan fails
- D. The people pray so enemies will rebuild the wall for them

26. [Esther] How does the reversal of Haman's plan fit the meaning of Purim?

- A. It shows Haman was secretly helping the Jews all along
- B. It proves revenge is always the main goal of God's people
- C. It teaches that royal power should never be challenged
- D. The threatened people are delivered, and the destroyer's own scheme falls back on him

27. [Nehemiah] Why are the covenant renewal scenes important after the wall is completed?

- A. They show that the goal is not just a safer city, but a people renewed in obedience to God
- B. They show the people no longer need leaders, priests, or Scripture
- C. They prove the wall itself forgives sin
- D. They mark the end of every future problem for Jerusalem

28. [Esther] What contrast does Esther show between Haman and Mordecai?

- A. Haman and Mordecai both seek power in exactly the same way
- B. Mordecai wants revenge on innocent people, while Haman seeks justice
- C. Haman's pride leads to destruction, while Mordecai's faithfulness is honored
- D. Both men disappear before the conflict is resolved

29. [Nehemiah] What warning comes from the reforms Nehemiah has to repeat near the end of the book?

- A. The wall should have been torn down again after it was finished
- B. Real faithfulness often needs ongoing correction, not just one emotional moment
- C. Ezra had read the wrong scroll to the people
- D. Nehemiah had never cared about worship or justice

30. [Esther] How do Esther's choices show courage that is different from simple boldness?

- A. She rushes into action without listening to advice or preparing
- B. She depends only on beauty and refuses to involve her people
- C. She accepts real risk, seeks support through fasting, and acts wisely for others
- D. She avoids danger by letting Mordecai speak to the king in her place